Brown Butter Chocolate Chunk Cookies

A detailed, eggless pastry recipe with optional chocolate dipping and a vanilla ice-cream serving idea

Yield: approximately 12–14 cookies | **Portion:** 25–28 g dough per cookie | **Active time:** 30–40 minutes | **Chilling:** at least 60 minutes | **Baking:** approximately 10–13 minutes | **Oven:** 170°C conventional / 160°C fan | **Dietary:** eggless, vegetarian
Developed for a home or small-batch pastry kitchen. Use a digital scale for repeatable results.

1. Ingredients

Weigh ingredients in grams for consistency. This formula makes thick, soft-centred cookies with a nutty brown-butter flavour. Cookie spread depends on dough temperature, flour absorption and oven accuracy.

Unsalted butter, before browning	**120 g**
Plain flour	**175 g**
Cornflour / cornstarch	**8 g**
Light brown sugar	**90 g**
Caster sugar	**40 g**
Milk powder	**10 g**
Milk	**25 g**
Vanilla extract	**5 g**
Baking soda	**2 g**
Baking powder	**1 g**
Fine salt	**2 g**
Dark chocolate chunks	**100 g**
Milk chocolate chunks	**40 g**

Optional finishing: 150–200 g melted chocolate for dipping or partial coating. For a cookie-and-ice-cream plate, use one small cookie, one modest scoop of vanilla ice cream and about 3–5 ml chocolate sauce per serving.

2. Equipment & preparation

Equipment: digital scale, saucepan, heatproof spatula, mixing bowl, whisk, sieve, baking tray, baking parchment, small scoop or spoon, cooling rack and oven thermometer if available. **Prepare the oven:** preheat to 170°C conventional or 160°C fan. Oven temperatures vary; use an oven thermometer if possible. **Prepare the chocolate:** chop chocolate into irregular 5–8 mm chunks. Keep a few larger pieces for visible chocolate pockets. **Measure everything first:** weigh the butter before browning. Keep the milk ready to replace moisture lost in browning. Do not add ingredients straight from unmeasured containers.

3. Step-by-step method

Step 1 — Brown the butter

Cut 120 g butter into even pieces and place in a light-coloured saucepan. Melt over medium heat, swirling the pan occasionally. It will foam; beneath the foam, milk solids will turn golden and then amber. When it smells nutty and the solids are amber — not black — remove it from the heat immediately. Pour into a heatproof bowl, scraping in the browned solids. Aim for about 95–100 g browned butter. Let cool until warm and fluid, not hot.

Step 2 — Cool and balance the butter

Allow the browned butter to cool until it is no longer hot to the touch. Whisk in 25 g milk gradually. The mixture may look temporarily uneven; keep whisking until it is reasonably combined. Add 5 g vanilla. Avoid adding milk to dangerously hot butter because it may splatter.

Step 3 — Mix the sugars

Add 90 g light brown sugar and 40 g caster sugar. Whisk for 30–45 seconds until evenly moistened. This is not an egg-based creaming method: the mixture will remain glossy and somewhat grainy, not pale and fluffy.

Step 4 — Combine the dry ingredients

Sift together 175 g plain flour, 8 g cornflour, 10 g milk powder, 2 g baking soda, 1 g baking powder and 2 g fine salt. Add to the butter-sugar mixture in two additions. Fold with a spatula just until only a few dry streaks remain. Do not knead; overmixing can make the cookies tougher.

Step 5 — Add chocolate

Add 100 g dark chocolate chunks and 40 g milk chocolate chunks. Fold until evenly distributed and no loose flour remains. The dough should be thick and scoopable. If it is warm or greasy, let it cool briefly before portioning.

Step 6 — Portion and chill

Weigh portions of 25–28 g for small cookies. Shape gently into portions without compressing them excessively. Place on a lined tray with space between portions. Cover and chill for at least 60 minutes; 2–12 hours can improve flavour and help control spread. Keep the portions round before baking.

Step 7 — Bake

Arrange chilled portions on a parchment-lined tray, leaving about 5 cm between them. Bake at 170°C conventional / 160°C fan for approximately 10–13 minutes, until edges are set and lightly golden while the centres still look slightly soft. Do not wait for the centres to look completely firm in the oven.

Step 8 — Shape and cool

Immediately after baking, if needed, use a round cutter slightly wider than a cookie to gently nudge the edges into a neat circle. Leave on the tray for 8–10 minutes; the cookies are fragile when hot. Transfer to a rack and cool completely before dipping in chocolate.

4. Optional chocolate dipping

Only dip completely cooled cookies. Melt 150–200 g couverture or compound chocolate gently in a dry bowl. Avoid water or steam entering the chocolate. For couverture, temper it according to the chocolate manufacturer’s instructions for a firm, glossy set. Compound coating generally does not require tempering; follow its package directions. Hold a cooled cookie and dip one edge or the lower third into the chocolate. Lift it slowly and allow excess chocolate to drip back into the bowl. Place on parchment and leave at a cool room temperature until set. Avoid refrigerating uncovered, which can cause condensation and dull the finish.

5. Serving idea: cookie, vanilla ice cream & chocolate sauce

Place one 6–7 cm cookie on a small dessert plate. Add one modest scoop of vanilla ice cream, approximately 35–45 g. Drizzle only 3–5 ml chocolate sauce over the scoop using a small spoon. A small spoon cannot pour an endless stream: tilt it once and stop when empty. Serve immediately while the cookie is crisp at the edge and the ice cream is cold.

6. Troubleshooting

Cookies spread too much Dough too warm, too little flour, tray warm or oven too cool.	**Chill longer; verify oven temperature; weigh flour and portions.**
Cookies stay too domed Dough very cold, portions too large or excess flour.	**Use the stated portion size; check weighing and flour measurement.**
Greasy dough Butter mixture too warm or liquid balance off.	**Cool butter before mixing; weigh browned butter and add milk gradually.**
Dry or cakey centre Overbaking or excess flour.	**Remove when edges set and centres are still slightly soft; weigh flour.**
Burnt brown flecks Milk solids scorched during browning.	**Use medium heat; remove at amber, not dark brown/black; pour out promptly**
	Follow package directions; temper couverture correctly and keep tools dry.

Chocolate coating won’t set	Chocolate type, temperature or tempering issue.

7. Storage & food-safety notes

Store fully cooled cookies in an airtight container at room temperature for about 3–4 days for best texture. Freeze unbaked, portioned dough well wrapped for up to about 2 months; bake from chilled or frozen, allowing extra time and checking doneness. Keep ice cream frozen and plate it immediately before serving. These are practical quality guidelines; local food-safety requirements and storage conditions take precedence.

Chef’s final checks

- Brown butter smells nutty and has amber, not black, milk solids.
- Dough is cool enough to portion and has no dry flour pockets.
- Portions are weighed consistently and chilled before baking.
- Cookies are fully cooled before chocolate dipping.
- For the ice-cream serving, keep the cookie modest in size and limit the chocolate sauce to a controlled drizzle.